

Spatializing Your Research: Formulating a Spatial Research Question

Spatializing Prompts	Space to Brainstorm	Relevant Data and Sources
Spatialize your research material: how is your work “in place”? <i>Is your research...</i> <i>...grounded in a specific location or set of locations (a site, neighborhood, corridor, coastline, campus, border, watershed)?</i> <i>...tied to an institution that operates from a specific location (a state agency, university, NGO, firm, or infrastructure)?</i> <i>...at the level of a city/region/country, where the same phenomenon looks different</i> <i>...about people, and where they are located shapes access, risk, resources, mobility, visibility, or power?</i> <i>...about movement/flows/networks across places (routes, supply chains, migration, data, water, money, infrastructure)?</i>		
Pin down your spatial logic: scale, relationship, and time <i>Scale: At what scale does your question become visible (body/building, block, neighborhood, city, region, nation, transnational)? If you zoomed in or out, what might change about the story?</i> <i>Relationship: What is the key relationship you want to reveal across space? (proximity, boundaries, connectivity, clustering/hotspots)</i> <i>Time: Is this a snapshot or a change story (before/after, seasonal, event-driven, slow shift, historical layering)?</i>		